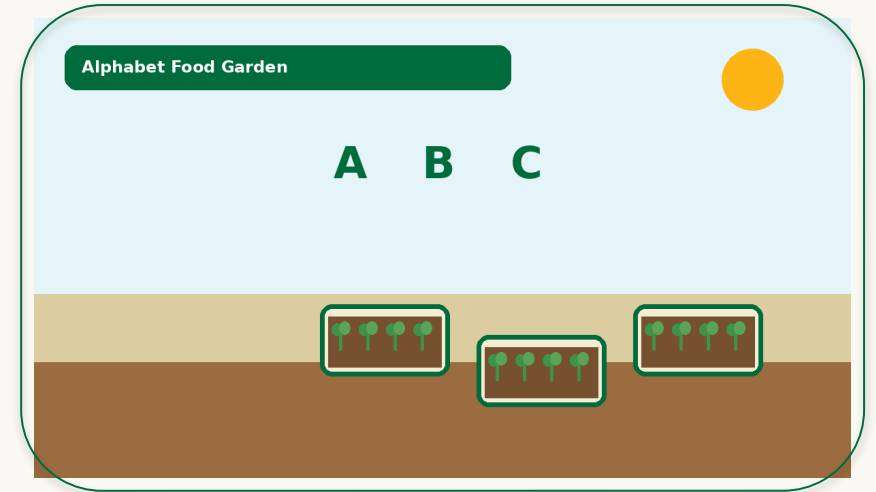


Alphabet Food Garden

Literacy, Crops and Food

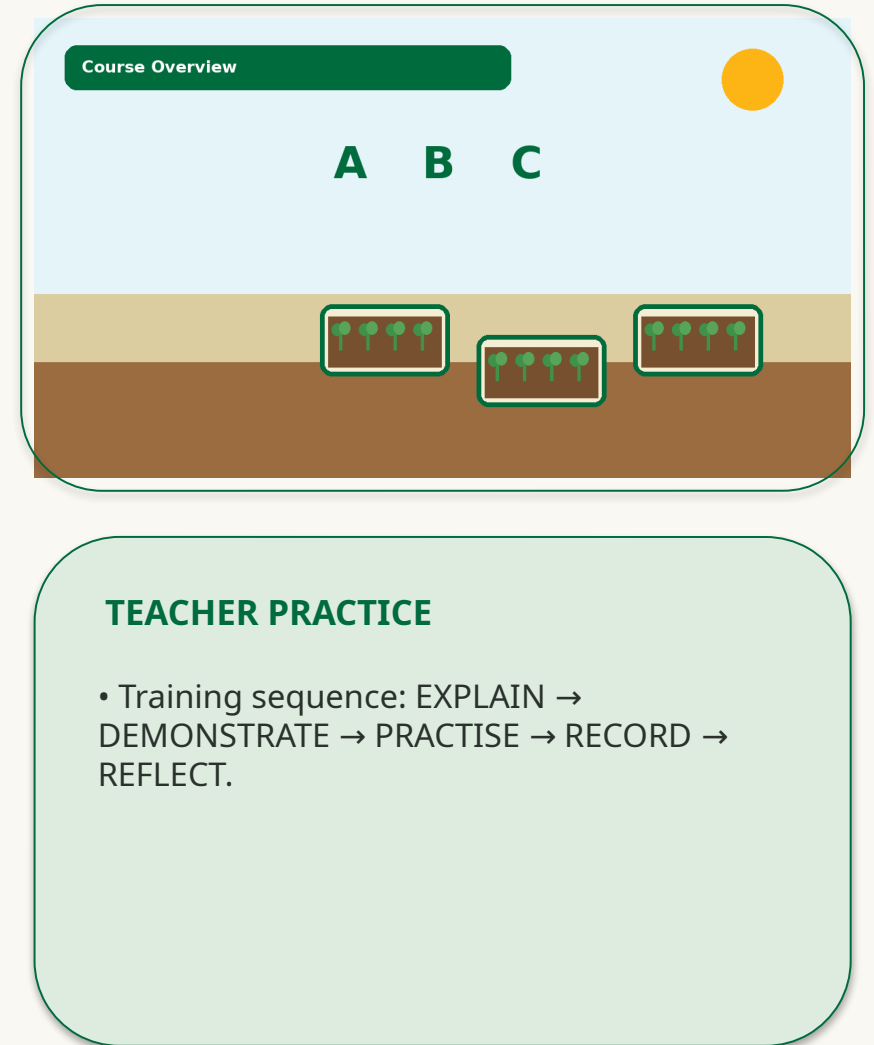
- LIFEWS AgriShine™ GrowMeal™ Primary 1-3 Teacher Training
- Audience: Primary 1-3 teachers, teaching assistants and garden facilitators
- Format: Self-paced online course + supervised practical orientation
- Recommended duration: 3 hours online + 60-90 minutes garden practical



Course Overview

Learning outcomes, materials and teacher readiness

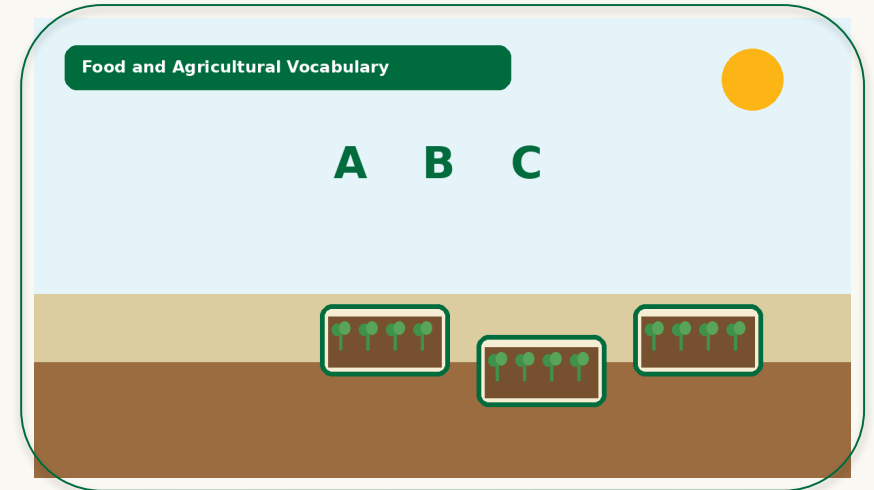
- Learning outcomes: explain the garden's educational and production purpose; teach the ten course topics accurately; connect practical gardening to Primary 1-3 curriculum; supervise age-appropriate garden work; maintain simple records; assess learning through practical and classroom evidence.
- Core materials: teacher guide, crop/word/number cards as relevant, child-safe hand tools, watering equipment, labels, clipboards, rulers/measuring tools where relevant, observation/record sheets, clean harvest containers, handwashing supplies and first-aid access.
- Completion expectation: complete all modules, demonstrate one safe garden lesson, and submit a short lesson/assessment plan.



Food and Agricultural Vocabulary

Teacher knowledge and practical application

- Build vocabulary from real crops, tools, actions and foods children can see in the garden.
- Start with familiar words such as seed, soil, leaf, root, water, hoe, bean and harvest.
- Model pronunciation, meaning and use in a short sentence.
- Revisit the same words during planting, care and harvest so vocabulary is connected to experience.
- Use picture-word cards only after children have observed the real object where possible.



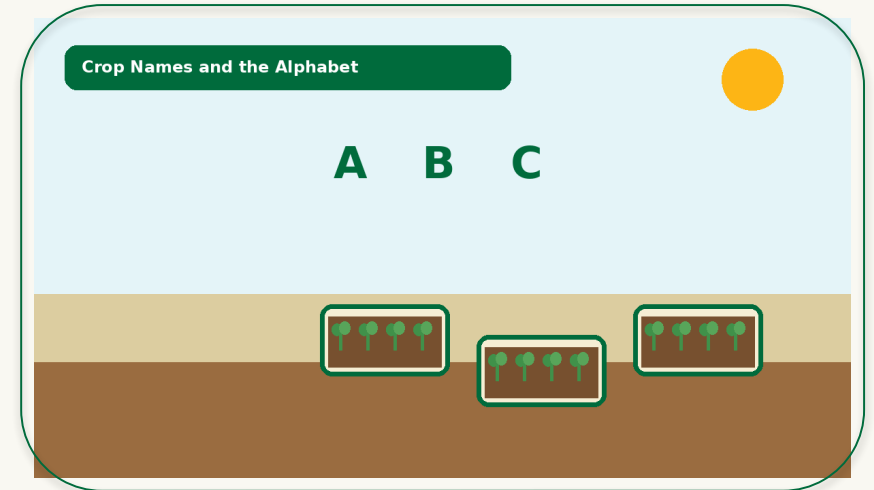
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Prepare 10 locally relevant garden words for the first lesson.

Crop Names and the Alphabet

Teacher knowledge and practical application

- Connect crop names with initial letters and sounds: B-bean, C-carrot, M-maize, O-onion.
- Use locally appropriate crops rather than forcing unsuitable examples for difficult letters.
- Sort crop cards alphabetically with teacher support.
- Compare crops that begin with the same sound or letter.
- Use an alphabet garden map or labels to reinforce print awareness.



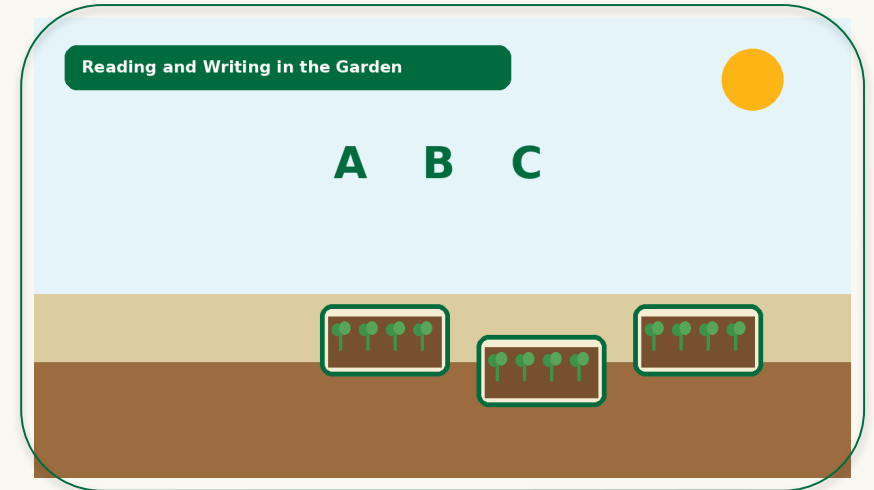
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Create 8 accurate crop-letter pairs from the school garden.

Reading and Writing in the Garden

Teacher knowledge and practical application

- Use short labels, signs, word cards and simple sentences tied to garden activity.
- Read labels aloud before children copy or complete selected words.
- Use sentence frames such as 'I planted ___' and 'The leaf is ___'.
- Allow drawing plus labels for learners still developing writing fluency.
- Keep writing tasks short so they do not replace practical garden experience.



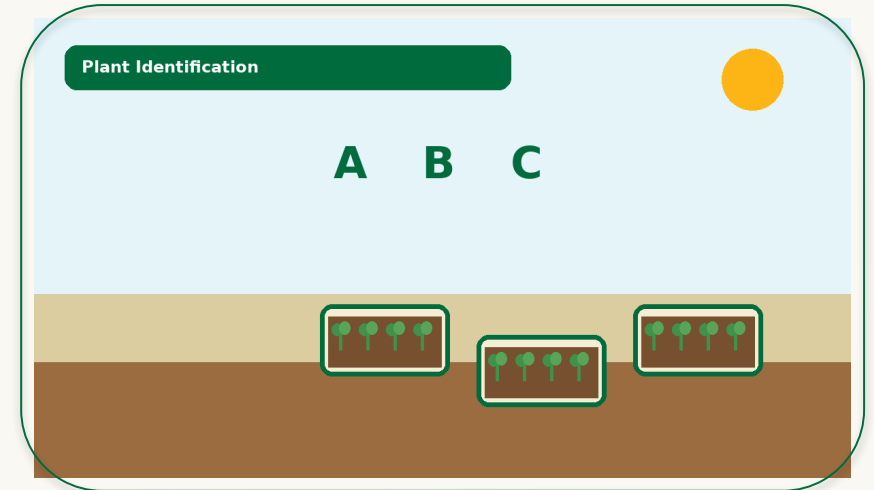
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Prepare one garden sentence frame and one labeling activity.

Plant Identification

Teacher knowledge and practical application

- Teach children to identify selected crops using more than one feature: leaf, stem, growth form, flower or fruit.
- Avoid identification based only on a single color or size feature.
- Use side-by-side comparison of two crops.
- Ask children to name the plant and one visible feature.
- Revisit identification as crops change through the season.



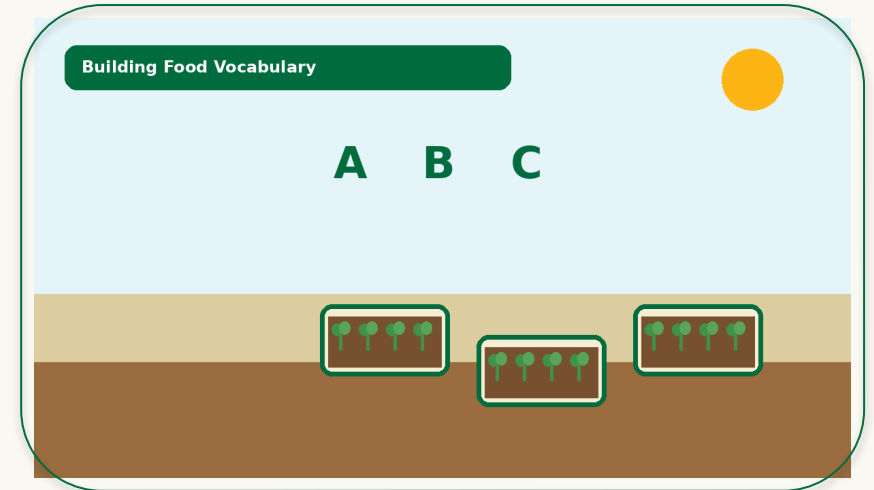
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Select four crops children should recognize independently.

Building Food Vocabulary

Teacher knowledge and practical application

- Connect crops to edible plant parts and familiar meals.
- Teach words such as leafy vegetable, fruit, seed, root crop and herb at an age-appropriate level.
- Discuss raw versus cooked only with safe, familiar examples.
- Use harvest baskets and food pictures to connect garden and kitchen vocabulary.
- Respect local food culture and avoid labeling unfamiliar foods as 'bad' or 'strange'.



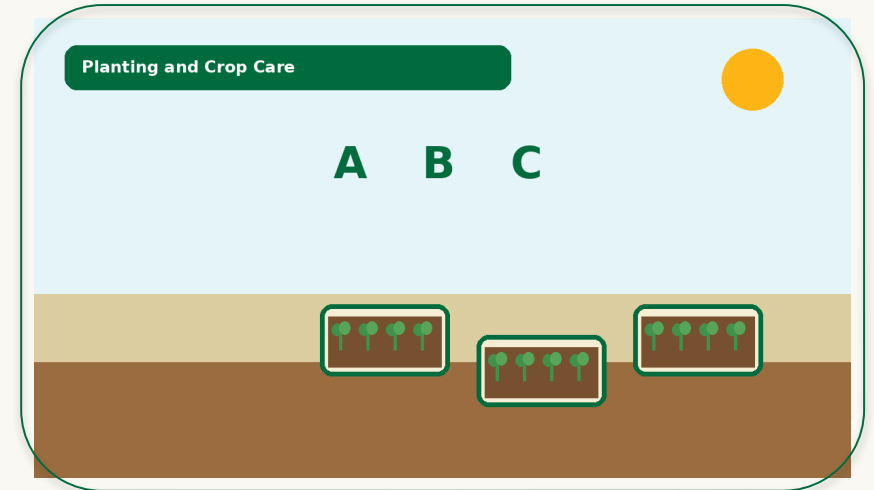
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Prepare a crop-to-food matching activity.

Planting and Crop Care

Teacher knowledge and practical application

- Teach action vocabulary while performing the action: dig, sow, transplant, cover, water, weed, mulch.
- Demonstrate each task before pupils begin.
- Use correct crop spacing and planting depth even when the literacy goal is primary.
- Assign short roles so children can talk about what they are doing.
- End with a spoken or written reflection using target words.



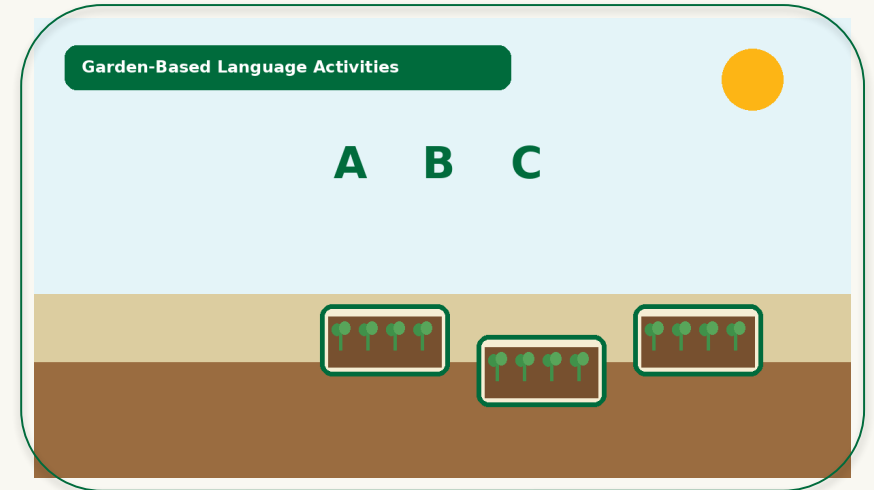
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Plan a planting task that teaches five action words.

Garden-Based Language Activities

Teacher knowledge and practical application

- Use I Spy, word hunts, picture-word matching, garden storytelling and oral description.
- Ask open questions that require words rather than one-word guessing.
- Let pupils describe a plant to a partner without naming it.
- Build a class word wall from words actually encountered in the garden.
- Use short garden stories to sequence events from seed to harvest.



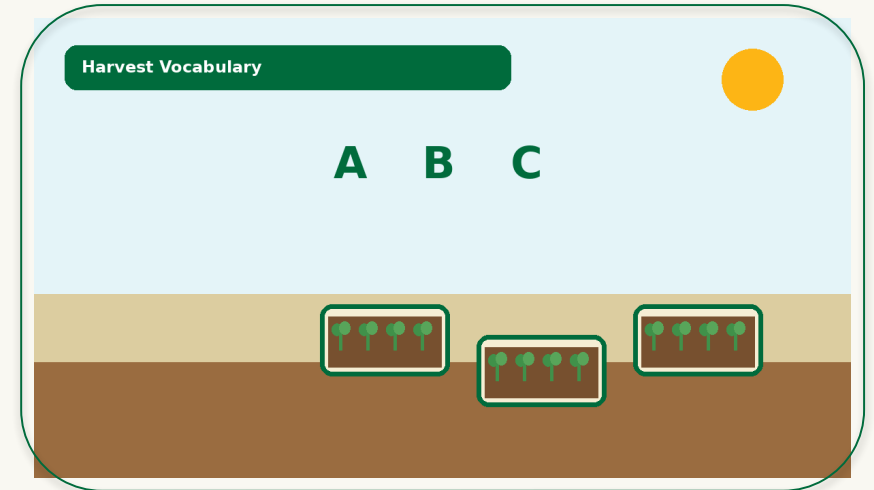
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Choose two activities for a 30-minute language lesson.

Harvest Vocabulary

Teacher knowledge and practical application

- Teach ripe, ready, pick, cut, basket, bunch, count, wash, share and store as appropriate.
- Explain that harvest methods differ among crops.
- Use harvested produce for oral description and simple labeling.
- Connect harvest vocabulary to quantities, colors, textures and plant parts.
- Follow food-safety rules if produce will be tasted.



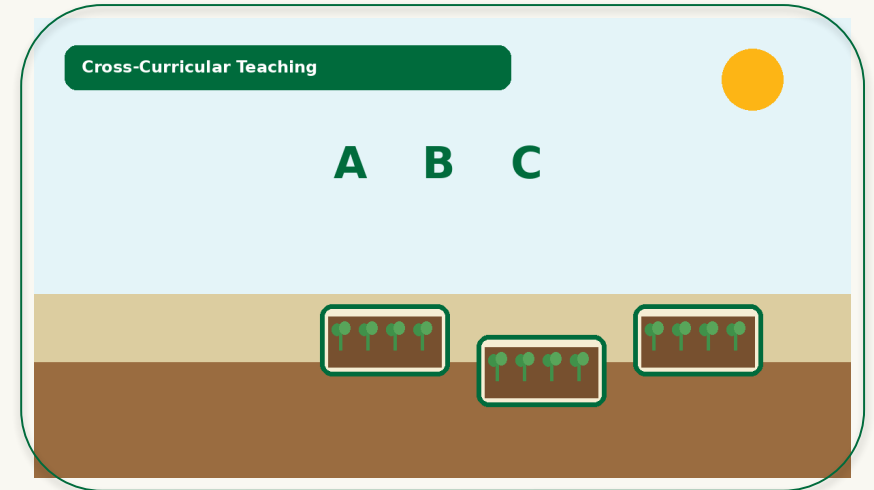
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Prepare a harvest word-and-picture set.

Cross-Curricular Teaching

Teacher knowledge and practical application

- Link literacy with numeracy through counting and recording; science through plant parts and growth; art through observational drawing.
- Keep one clear primary learning objective for each lesson.
- Use the garden as context rather than trying to teach every subject at once.
- Coordinate vocabulary with classroom topics where possible.
- Record which curriculum outcomes the garden activity supports.



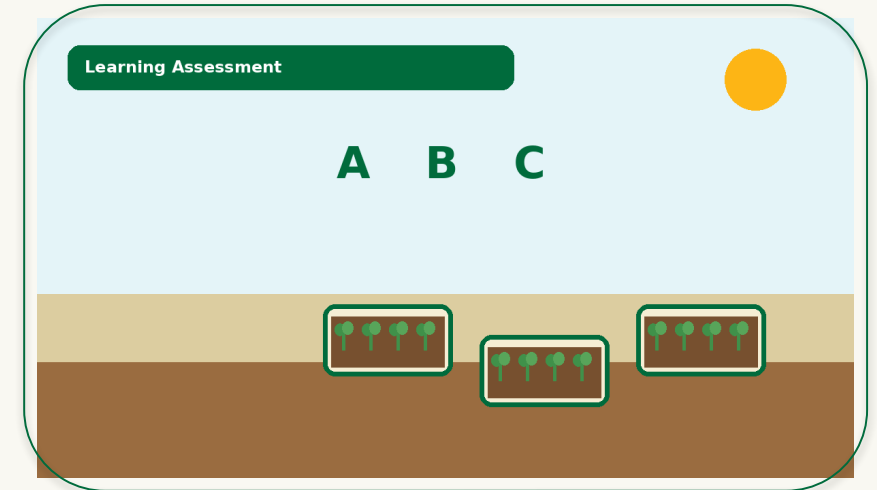
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Map one garden activity to literacy plus one other subject.

Learning Assessment

Teacher knowledge and practical application

- Assess whether pupils can name selected crops, read or recognize target words, use vocabulary in context and produce a simple label or sentence.
- Use oral responses, observation, drawings, labels and short written work.
- Record independent performance separately from heavily prompted answers.
- Assess repeatedly across the crop cycle.
- Use results to choose vocabulary for the next lesson.



TEACHER PRACTICE

- Completion task: design a 35-minute Alphabet Food Garden lesson.